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Interview Thesis Brief · GenAI Ops Solution Architect



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EXECUTIVE THESIS

CGI needs a centralized GenAIOps capability that reduces the cost and delay of doing the right architecture repeatedly. The role's product is not a platform diagram; it is an enterprise contract connecting use-case outcomes, reference patterns, identity and data boundaries, human authority, evaluation, observability, architecture decisions and sustainable ownership.

Real mandate

- Define and govern a reusable enterprise GenAI architecture.
- Turn RAG, AgentOps, ModelOps/LLMOps, evaluation, observability and governance into shared services.
- Accelerate use-case onboarding without externalizing risk or rework.
- Act as architecture authority while building engineering ownership and knowledge transfer.

Central contradiction

The platform must centralize what creates leverage while preserving enough domain context, cloud choice and team autonomy to remain useful. Over-centralize and teams route around it; under-govern and every use case rebuilds risk, evidence and integration from scratch.

Operating hypothesis

Architecture friction is probably accumulating at the seams: use-case intake, data/identity access, evaluation acceptance, cloud integration, architecture exceptions, production ownership and evidence handoff. This is a hypothesis for discovery, not a claim about CGI or its client.

Candidate point of view

Use an Enterprise AI Building Code: define the load, choose a bounded pattern, bind controls, specify evidence, instrument operation and transfer ownership. Architecture reviews become permit decisions with explicit conditions and reusable learning.

WHAT I WOULD LISTEN FOR

Demand signal

How use cases enter, who sponsors them, how value is framed, and where urgency bypasses architecture.

Platform reality

Existing services, cloud boundaries, model/provider choices, integration patterns, identity/data constraints and current technical debt.

Authority

Who can approve, condition, reject, stop or accept risk; how exceptions are documented and revisited.

Evidence

Acceptance suites, production telemetry, incident learning, cost transparency, adoption measures and value realization.

HARD OBJECTION

“You are not a conventional enterprise architect.”

Correct. I have not held a decade-long enterprise-architecture title or owned CGI's exact GenAIOps platform. My evidence is adjacent and operational: high-reliability engineering standards, complex integration and governance, large-scale operating mechanisms, telemetry-driven issue flow, regulated autonomous systems, and direct design of agentic/RAG workflows with human authority and evaluation. The value proposition is architecture that survives implementation, adoption and ownership—not title equivalence.

EXECUTIVE INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- 01 Where is GenAI demand currently entering the organization, and what percentage can move through an established reference pattern versus requiring architecture exceptions?
- 02 Which capability is creating the greatest onboarding drag today: data access, identity, retrieval, model choice, evaluation, observability, governance review, or production ownership?
- 03 What decision rights does this architect hold directly, and where must influence substitute for formal authority?
- 04 How do business, engineering, security, risk and operations agree that a GenAI use case is ready—not merely functional?
- 05 What production evidence is visible by use case today: quality, cost, latency, drift, incidents, recovery, human overrides and adoption?
- 06 How are architecture exceptions recorded, time-bounded and converted into platform learning rather than permanent one-off support?
- 07 Where does the client expect cloud portability, and where is provider-native leverage intentionally preferred?
- 08 What would this role have made measurably easier for engineering teams and business sponsors after twelve months?

EVIDENCE I WOULD ASK TO INSPECT

- Two or three recent use-case onboarding traces from demand through architecture review, release and operational ownership.
- A representative architecture decision record plus the exception history that followed it.
- The evaluation suite, production telemetry and incident/recovery evidence for one RAG or agentic workflow.
- The runbook and ownership model showing who carries quality, cost, risk and change after go-live.

FIRST-MEETING STANCE

Do not arrive with a platform rewrite. Establish the current load paths, exception patterns, authority boundaries and evidence gaps. Protect what already works. Make hidden architecture decisions visible. Select one bounded use case where a permit review can demonstrate faster, safer onboarding and leave a reusable artifact behind.